

Constitution of The Association of Mathematical and Computer Science Students

Updated as of August 20th, 2025

ARTICLE I

Name and Purpose

Section 1: Organization Name

1.1 Name. The official name of the Campus Group shall be The Association of Mathematical and Computer Science Students. The Campus Group shall be referred to as the “Association”.

1.2 Acronym. The Association may be referred to by the acronym AMACSS.

Section 2: Organization Purpose

2.1 Non-profit Status. The Association is a non-profit, student-run group that operates independently of any faculty, department, or administrative unit of the University of Toronto, to be referred as the “University”.

2.2 University Policy Compliance. The Association shall operate in accordance to the *Policy on the Recognition of Student Groups*—to be referred to as the “University Policy”—or any statute, which may be substituted therefore, as amended from time to time by the University of Toronto Governing Council.

2.3 Departmental Student Association. The Association shall be the official departmental student association of the Department of Computer and Mathematical Sciences at the University of Toronto Scarborough—to be referred to as the “CMS department”—as a registered student group of the University.

2.4 Purpose. The purpose, objectives, and mission of the Association is to represent, advocate for and enhance the university experience of students in the CMS department—to be referred to as “CMS students”—through the following:

1. To offer academic and professional support and provide resources to CMS students,
2. To foster a sense of community among CMS students through various social initiatives and activities,
3. To promote collaboration and networking opportunities among University students, recognized student groups, faculty, staff, and industry, and
4. To advocate for the interests and concerns of CMS students to the university administration and relevant bodies.

Section 3: Mission Statement

3.1 Mission Statement Purpose. The Association shall maintain a Mission Statement that reflects the purpose and objectives of the Association. The Mission Statement acts as the official interpretation of the Constitution and serves as the guiding document for all of the Association's activities, policies, and decision-making processes.

3.2 Mission Statement Composition. The Mission Statement shall be composed of the following elements:

1. Vision and Value: A statement outlining the long-term vision and core values that guide the Association's activities and interactions with the University and the broader community.
2. Code of Conduct: A statement outlining the expected standards of behaviour and ethical principles that all members of the Association are expected to uphold, including that of the board of executives, internal members, and general members.

3.3 Mission Statement Amendment. The Mission Statement shall be reviewed by every incoming Board of Executives and may be amended by a majority vote of the Board of Executives, provided that the proposed amendment is consistent with the Constitution. The Mission Statement shall only be amended during the first month of the Board's term and shall be made available to all members of the Association.

ARTICLE II

Membership

Section 1: Types of Membership

1.1 Memberships Offers. The Association shall offer three (3) types of memberships that are not necessarily mutually exclusive:

1. General (voting) membership,
2. Honorary (non-voting) membership, and
3. Paid (non-voting) membership.

1.2 Terms of Membership. The term of all memberships shall start after May 1st and end on April 30th of the following year.

1.3 Membership List. The Association shall maintain a list of members of the categories and ensure that membership is being offered in accordance with this constitution for every academic year.

Section 2: General Membership

2.1 General Membership Eligibility. The eligible for general (voting) membership shall be all undergraduate students currently registered at the CMS department.

2.2 General Membership Termination. General (voting) membership of the Association shall be automatically terminated if a member ceases to be a registered student at the CMS department or withdraws their membership.

2.3 General Membership Fee. There shall be no fee for general (voting) membership.

2.4 General Membership Rights. General members shall have the rights to:

1. Have one vote in Association referenda, and Members Meetings, and
2. Sign petitions related to the Association to enact referenda or to call for a special meeting of the members.

Section 3: Honorary Membership

3.1 Honorary Membership Purpose. The purpose of honorary membership is to recognize and honour individuals who have demonstrated exceptional dedication and service to the Association or the CMS department. The membership is intended to acknowledge faculty, staff, alumni, or community members who have positively impacted the Association or the CMS students.

3.2 Honorary Membership Eligibility. Honorary membership may be granted to any individual who has made significant contributions to the Association or the CMS department. They will be nominated and approved by the Board of Executives.

3.3 Honorary Membership Termination. Honorary membership may be revoked by a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote of the Board of Executives. Honorary members may also voluntarily withdraw their membership at any time.

Section 4: Paid Membership

4.1 Paid Membership Purpose. The purpose of paid membership is to provide additional benefits and services to members who choose to support the Association financially. Paid members may receive exclusive access to certain events, resources, or discounts, as determined by the Board of Executives.

4.2 Paid Membership Eligibility. Paid membership may be offered to individuals who may already be general members or honorary members, or to individuals who do not meet the criteria for general or honorary membership.

4.3 Paid Membership Fee. The fee for paid membership shall be determined by the Board of Executives and may be subject to change on an annual basis.

4.4 Paid Membership Termination. Paid membership shall be automatically terminated if a member fails to pay the membership fee within the specified time frame or withdraws their membership.

4.5 Paid Membership Rights. Paid members shall have the rights to access the benefits and services associated with their membership, as determined by the Board of Executives for the academic year. However, they shall not have voting rights unless they are also a general member.

ARTICLE III

Petitions and Referenda

Section 1: Petitions

1.1 Petition Purpose. Petitions may be initiated by any general member of the Association to propose referenda or to call for special meetings of the members to discuss specific issues related to the Association.

The goal of the petition process is to provide a mechanism for general members to officially raise concerns, propose changes, or seek collective decision-making on matters of importance to the Association.

1.2 Petition Scope. Petitions may be used to call in a special meeting of the members to discuss and vote on a specific issue or to trigger a referendum to vote on a specific issue related to the Association.

1.3 Petition Process.

1. (Submission) A petition must be submitted in writing to the Board of Executives and outline the specific issue or proposal, actionable clauses, and supporting documents if applicable.
2. (Review) Upon receipt of a petition, the Board shall review the petition to ensure that it meets the necessary requirements and is relevant to the Association's affairs and issue a response to the petitioner within two calendar weeks.
3. (Signature Requirement) The petition will be then served to all general members of the Association and must be signed by at least 10% of the general members of the Association within 4 calendar months of the petition's serving date to be considered valid.
4. (Verification) Upon receipt of a petition, the Board shall verify the validity of the petition, including confirming that it meets the signature requirement.
5. (Action) If a petition is deemed valid, the Board shall take appropriate action based on the nature of the petition, which may include scheduling a special meeting or initiating a referendum.
6. (Invalid Petitions) If a petition is deemed invalid, the Board shall provide a written explanation to the petitioner within ten (10) calendar days of the verification process, outlining the reasons for the invalidation and any necessary steps for correction.

1.4 Non-resubmission. A petition that did not meet the signature requirement within the specified time frame shall not be resubmitted for the same issue for a period of six (6) calendar months from the date of the petition's serving date.

Section 2: Referenda

2.1 Referendum Purpose. Referenda may be initiated by the Board of Executives or by a valid petition to allow general members to vote on specific issues related to the Association. The purpose of referenda is to enable direct democratic decision-making on important matters that affect the Association and its members.

2.2 Referendum Scope. Referenda may be held to vote on the following matters:

1. Amendments to the constitution,
2. Impeachment of a senior executive, and
3. Other matters as determined by the Board of Executives or through a valid petition.

The exact details on constitutional amendments and impeachment referenda are outlined in Articles 7, 8, and 9 of this constitution.

2.3 Referendum Process.

1. (Notice) The Board of Executives shall provide reasonable notice to general members about the upcoming referendum, including the issue being voted on, the rationale for the referendum, and instructions on how to participate in the voting process.
2. (Voting) General members shall have the opportunity to cast their votes in a secure and confidential manner, as determined by the Board of Executives. The voting period shall be open for a reasonable duration to allow all general members to participate.
3. (Outcome) The outcome of a referendum shall be determined by a simple majority vote of the general members who participated in the voting process. The results shall be announced promptly after the conclusion of the voting period.

ARTICLE IV

Board of Executives

Section 1: Board of Executives Composition

The Board of Executives—to be referred to as the “Board”—shall be the governing body of the Association and shall be responsible for the overall management and direction of the Association. The Board shall represent the interests of the members and serve the Association in accordance with this constitution, policies, and its constituents.

1.1 Term of Office. The term for all positions on the Board shall be from May 1st to April 30th of the following year.

1.2 Composition. The Board shall be comprised of two (2) committees: Senior Executives Committee and Executive Committee. These committee positions may hold voting or non-voting positions within the Board as specified.

Section 2: Board of Executives Eligibility and Restrictions

2.1 Voting Executives Eligibility. All voting members of the Board must be currently registered students of the University of Toronto.

2.2 Non-voting Executives Eligibility. Non-voting members may hold only non-voting positions on the Board. These positions may be held by individuals who are not currently registered students of the University of Toronto, such as faculty, staff, alumni, or community members.

2.3 Not Registered Student Executive Positions. The maximum amount of non-voting positions held by those who are not registered students on the Board shall be one (1) position or ten per cent (10%) of the positions on the Board, whichever is greatest.

2.4 Restrictions on Non-voting Executive. Persons holding non-voting positions on the Board cannot serve as an officer, financial authority, signing authority, primary contact, or secondary contact.

2.5 One Voting Executive Incumbency Policy. There shall be no individual who may hold more than one (1) voting position on the Board at any given time unless they are serving as acting capacity for an unfilled position, to which they still only hold one (1) vote in the Board. There also shall only be one (1) incumbent per voting position on the Board at any given time.

2.6 Financial Authority Restrictions. No person may serve as a financial authority or signing authority for the Association if they are currently serving as a financial authority or signing authority for another recognized student group at the University of Toronto.

2.7 Appointment of Directors or Coordinators. The Board of Executives may appoint Directors or Coordinators for various committees who do not hold executive decision-making authority and are not eligible to cast votes at meetings of the Board.

Section 3: Senior Executive Committee

3.1 Senior Executive Positions. The Senior Executive Committee shall consist of the following four (4) voting positions elected by the Association general members:

1. President,
2. Senior Vice-President Communications,
3. Senior Vice-President Academic Affairs, and
4. Senior Vice-President Operations.

3.2 Senior Executive Purpose. The Senior Executive Committee shall be the chief governing body of the Association and shall be responsible for the overall strategic management and direction of the Association. Each Senior Vice-President shall oversee a specific division of the Association and are directly responsible for the strategic operations and future growth of their respective divisions.

3.3 Non-voting Senior Executive Positions. The Senior Executive Committee shall additionally have one (1) Chief of Staff as a non-voting position appointed by the Senior Executive Committee.

3.4 Senior Executive Exclusion Policy. No Senior Executive Committee member may hold any other executive position from any other recognized student group at the University of Toronto during their incumbency.

3.5 President. The President shall be the chief executive officer over internal organization and the figurehead representing all members of the Association. The President shall:

1. Oversee and manage the organization, maintain the integrity of the Association, and ensure all events and functions align with the mission of the Association,
2. Act as the primary representative and spokesperson for the Association in all official matters, including interactions with University offices, the Scarborough Campus Student Union, other recognized student groups, external organizations, and the public as a Departmental Student Association,
3. Lead the Senior Executive Committee in strategic planning and decision-making processes of the Association accross all sectors,
4. Conduct meetings of the Board of Executives and general members, ensuring effective communication and collaboration among all members of the team,

5. Write executive orders and ensure the enforcement of the constitution, policies, and procedures of the Association, and,
6. Hold special veto privileges over decisions made by the Board of Executives as specified.

3.6 Senior Vice-President Communications. The Senior Vice-President Communications shall be the chief communications officer of the Association and oversee strategic development and operations of the Communications Division. The Senior Vice-President Communications shall:

1. Develop and implement communication strategies to effectively reach and engage CMS students, promote Association events, disseminate important information to University bodies and external organizations,
2. Manage the Association's public presence with general members, University bodies, recognized student groups, and external organizations,
3. Act as the first point of contact for the Association in internal department affairs, such as general members, CMS recognized student groups, and the CMS department, and
4. Direct and supervise the vice-presidents and other team members of the Communications Division.

3.7 Senior Vice-President Academic Affairs. The Senior Vice-President Academic Affairs shall be the chief academics officer of the Association and oversee strategic development and operations of the Academic Division. The Senior Vice-President Academic Affairs shall:

1. Liaise with faculty members, general members, academic advisors, and other relevant stakeholders to address academic concerns and advocate for the needs of CMS students,
2. Develop, implement, and maintain academic support programs, workshops, and resources to enhance the academic experience of CMS students according to the mission of the Association, and
3. Direct and supervise the vice-presidents and other team members of the Academic Division to serve the academic needs of the CMS students.

3.8 Senior Vice-President Operations. The Senior Vice-President Operations shall be the chief operations officer of the Association and oversee strategic development and operations of the Operations Division. The Senior Vice-President Operations shall:

1. Oversee the planning, coordination, and execution of events, initiatives, and services provided by the Association to CMS students,
2. Manage logistical aspects of the Association's activities, including venue bookings, resource allocation, and volunteer coordination, and
3. Direct and supervise the vice-presidents and other team members of the Operations Division.

3.9 Chief of Staff. The Chief of Staff shall be the primary aide to the Senior Executive Committee and assist in the coordination and management of the Board of Executives and the Association internal conduct. The Chief of Staff shall:

1. Assist the Senior Executive Committee in strategic planning, decision-making, and execution of the Association's mission,
2. Ensure the Board of Executives operates efficiently, effectively, and in accordance with the Association's constitution, policies and procedures,
3. Advise executive members on best practices, governance, and organizational improvements,
4. Moderate meetings of the Board of Executives and chair member meetings, and
5. Manage special projects, initiatives, and tasks as assigned by the Senior Executive Committee.

Section 4: Executive Committee

4.1 Executive Committee Positions. The Executive Committee offices shall consist of the following (10) voting positions appointed by the Senior Executive Committee:

1. Vice-President Academics
2. Vice-President Review Seminars
3. Vice-President Finance
4. Vice-President Logistics
5. Vice-President Lounge
6. Vice-President Special Events
7. Vice-President University Affairs
8. Vice-President Sponsorship
9. Vice-President Engagement
10. Vice-President Marketing

4.2 Interim Vice-Presidents. There may be interim vice-presidents appointed by the Senior Executive Committee for the following reasons:

1. A vice-president position is vacant, or
2. The Senior Executive Committee deems it necessary to appoint a person who does not meet the eligibility requirements as stated in §IV.2.1 for their expertise and value they can contribute to the Association. This interim vice-president shall be a non-voting member on the Board to comply with the University Policy.

4.3 Acting Vice-President. In the event that a vice-president is unable to perform their duties for a temporary period of time, the Senior Executive Committee may appoint an acting vice-president to fulfill the responsibilities of the position during that time. The acting vice-president shall have the same rights and responsibilities as a regular vice-president, but their appointment shall be temporary and subject to review by the Senior Executive Committee.

4.4 Coordinators. The Executive Committee may additionally have non-voting executive positions called Coordinators that are appointed by the Senior Executive Committee to lead special projects or work with various teams.

ARTICLE V

Policies and Procedures

Section 1: Policies

The purpose of policies served as the official guidelines and framework for the Board of Executives to make informed decisions and take actions that are consistent with the Association's mission and values.

1.1 Board Authority to Establish Policies. The Board of Executives is authorized to establish, amend, and enforce policies and procedures consistent with this constitution to govern the operational affairs of the Association.

1.2 Matters Subject to Policy. The Board may establish policies regarding:

1. Operational procedures and implementation guidelines,
2. Meeting conduct and participation requirements,
3. Financial management and expenditure guidelines,
4. Event planning and resource allocation,
5. Committee formation and standing committee operations, and
6. Other matters necessary for the effective operation of the Association.

1.3 Types of Policies. Policies may be established in the following forms:

1. Policy Statements: Policies that provide high-level principles and guidelines for the Board's decision-making and actions on specific matters.
2. Procedure Policies: Policies that provide detailed steps and guidelines for the implementation of specific policies established by the Board.
3. Committee Policies: Policies that govern the formation, operation, and responsibilities of standing committees of the Association.

1.4 Constitutional Supremacy. All policies and procedures shall be subordinate to this Constitution. In the event of conflict between a policy and this Constitution, the Constitution shall prevail.

1.5 Mission Statement Guidance. Policies shall be consistent with the Association's current Mission Statement and shall not contradict the values and principles outlined therein.

1.6 Policy Requirements. Policies shall be clear, specific, and actionable through Procedures. Policies shall provide rational and sufficient guidance for implementation and enforcement by the Board of Executives.

1.7 Policy Adoption Process. Policies may be adopted by the Board of Executives through majority vote, provided that notice and a reasonable opportunity for discussion have been given to Board members.

1.8 Member Notice. Adopted policies shall be made available to general members and maintained as a record accessible to all members.

1.9 Policy Amendment. Policies may be amended or repealed by the Board of Executives in the same manner as adoption.

1.10 Policy Review and Enforcement. The Board shall periodically review existing policies to ensure their continued relevance and consistency with the Constitution and the Association's mission.

Section 2: Standard Operating Procedures

Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) are detailed, step-by-step instructions that outline the specific actions and processes required to implement policies established by the Board of Executives. SOPs provide clear guidance to ensure consistent and effective execution of the policies in practice and other operational matters of the Association.

2.1 Board Authority to Establish Procedures. The Board of Executives is authorized to establish, amend, and enforce SOPs consistent with this Constitution and the policies established by the Board to govern the operational affairs of the Association.

2.2 SOPs Consistent with Policies. SOPs shall be consistent with the policies established by the Board and shall provide detailed guidance on the implementation of those policies.

2.3 SOP Adoption and Amendment. SOPs may be adopted and amended by the Board of Executives either through discretionary authority or through a majority vote, provided that notice and a reasonable opportunity for discussion have been given to Board members.

ARTICLE VI

Meetings

Section 1: Board Meetings

Section 2: General Member Meetings

ARTICLE VII

Elections of Senior Executive

Section 1: Election Logistics

1.1 Election Timing. Elections for all voting positions on the Senior Executive Committee shall be held annually in the month of February and to be completed by the end of March.

1.2 Election Process. All voting positions on the Executive Committee shall be filled through an annual election. All voting-members of the Board shall have one (1) vote for each position on the Senior Executive Committee.

1.3 Candidate Eligibility. The eligible for all candidates on the Senior Executive Committee—in addition to the requirements of §IV.2.1—shall either be:

1. A current member of the Board, or
2. Nominated by one (1) member of the Board, or
3. Nominated by twenty five (25) general members of the Association.

1.4 Election Winners. The candidate winning the simple majority of votes cast in the election for each position shall be deemed the winner. In an event that no candidate receives a simple majority of votes cast, a runoff election shall be held between the two (2) candidates with the highest number of votes.

ARTICLE VIII

Removal of Senior Executive

Section 1: Removal Procedures

Section 2: Appeal Process

ARTICLE IX

Amendments

Amendments to this Constitution may be proposed and adopted in accordance with the procedures outlined in this Article. The purpose of amendments is to allow for necessary changes and improvements to the governance structure and operations of the Association while ensuring that such changes are made through a transparent and democratic process.

The power of amendment is vested in the general membership of the Association, and any amendment to this Constitution shall be subject to ratification by a majority of the general membership.

Section 1: Amendment Procedures

1.1 Amendments Proposal. Amendments to this Constitution may be proposed by any general member of the Association through a petition. Amendments may also be proposed by any member of the Board of Executives without requirement of a petition.

1.2 Board Review. The Board shall review and consider all proposed amendments and may either approve or reject them. The process of reviewing a petition or proposed amendment by the Board are outlined in §III.1.3 of this Constitution.

1.3 Call for Special Meeting of Members. If a proposed amendment is approved by the Board, the Board shall call for a special meeting of the general membership to discuss and vote on the proposed amendment. The special meeting shall be held within a reasonable time frame after the approval of the proposed amendment by the Board, and all general members shall be given reasonable notice and opportunity to participate in the meeting.

Section 2: Ratification

2.1 Vote by Referendum. An amendment to this Constitution shall be voted on through a referendum and ratifies if it receives a simple majority of votes cast held among the general membership of the Association. The referendum for ratification of an amendment shall follow the same procedures outlined in §III.2.3 of this Constitution.

2.2 Ratification. If an amendment is ratified by the general membership, it shall become effective immediately upon the announcement of the referendum results, unless otherwise specified in the amendment itself. The amendment shall then be incorporated into this Constitution and shall be binding on all members of the Association.